

$\text{♩} = 100$ $\text{♩} = 100$

11 10. 11 10
Joseph Barnby
(1838-96)

Brightest and best of the sons of the morning

Reginald Heber
(1783-1826)

The first system of the musical score is written for piano in 3/4 time, featuring a treble and bass staff. The key signature has two flats (B-flat and E-flat). The melody in the treble staff begins with a half note G3, followed by quarter notes A3, B-flat3, and C4. The bass staff provides a simple accompaniment with quarter notes. The system concludes with a double bar line and repeat dots.

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The second system of the musical score continues the piano accompaniment from the first system. It includes four stanzas of lyrics aligned with the musical measures. The lyrics are as follows:

1 Brightest and best of the sons of the morning,
Dawn on our darkness, and lend us thine aid;
Star of the east, the horizon adorning,
Guide where our infant Redeemer is laid.

2 Cold on his cradle the dew-drops are shining;
Low lies his head with the beasts of the stall;
Angels adore him in slumber reclining,
Maker and Monarch and Saviour of all.

3 Say, shall we yield him, in costly devotion,
Odours of Edom, and offerings divine,
Gems of the mountain, and pearls of the ocean,
Myrrh from the forest, or gold from the mine?

4 Vainly we offer each ample oblation,
Vainly with gifts would his favour secure:
Richer by far is the heart's adoration,
Dearer to God are the prayers of the poor.

The third system of the musical score continues the piano accompaniment. It features the same treble and bass staves, maintaining the 3/4 time signature and two-flat key signature. The system ends with a double bar line and repeat dots.